In fact, he never parted from his keen-edged sword. It always lay hanging to his waist or settled in his hands. It was claimed that he was a man with rustic and rough speech owing to having grown up in an out-of-the-way place.

## The Khāns Go Against Taṃbal

Soon after the younger Khān returned to Tashkent, they led out an army for Andijān directing an attack straight against Sulṭān Aḥmad Taṃbal on the fifteenth (21 July) day of Muharram in AD 1502. He chose to march on the road over the Kīndīrlīk-pass. He had instructed the younger Khān and Babur to leave from the blacksmith's-dale well in advance. After the Kīndīrlīk-pass had been crossed, they all met near Zarqān of Karnān. They counted their men and came to be no lesser than 30,000.

They heard the news that Taṃbal had also begun to collate his men and was heading to Akhsī. Hearing the news, the Khāns consulted together and decided to send a few men with Babur. He was supposed to cross the Khujand water, march by the way of Aūsh and Aūzkīnt, and bring havoc of attack on Taṃbal's rear side. Babur was assigned Ayūb Begchīk with his Tūmān, Jān-ḥasan Bārīn (var. Nārīn) with his Bārīns, Muḥammad Ḥiṣārī Dūghlāt, Sulṭān Ḥusain Dūghlāt, and Sulṭān Aḥmad Mīrzā Dūghlāt to campaign a rear attack. Their force was being commanded by Sārīgh-bāsh Mīrza Itārchī.

Seeing off the Khāns in Karnān, the men under Babur crossed the river on rafts near Sakan. They traversed the Khūqān sub-district, crushing Qabā and by way of the Alāī sub-districts, finally descending on Osh with complete vigour. Babur had made it to the place at dawn and the foe was taken by surprise. They had no option but to surrender. The people of the country had always been by their side but the remoteness of the Khāns and Babur himself buttressed by the dread of Taṃbal kept them off any action. After Babur barged into Osh, the tribesmen of highland and lowland, southern and eastern Andijān joined hands with him. The people of Aūzkīnt too came in support of Babur.

The Marghīnānīs had also come to join Babur. They beat and chased their commandant black and blue. Every fort to the south of Khujand, except Andijān, had come forward to join hands with Babur. The truth was that